

ATTRACTION: Akshyavat

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Akshay Vat

LOCATION:

Maranpur, Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya

CATEGORY:

Religious Site / Heritage Site

OVERVIEW:

Akshyavat, located in Maranpur, Gaya, means "everlasting, indestructible Banyan Tree". It is a highly revered site where Pind Daan (offerings to ancestors) is performed. The Pinda Daan ritual starts from the Falgu River and finishes at Akshay Vat. According to belief, this tree received a boon from Sita that it can never die.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Akshyavat is a sacred and immortal banyan tree in Gaya. It holds immense importance for Hindu pilgrims performing Pind Daan rituals for their ancestors. The ritual traditionally concludes near this tree. The tree is considered indestructible and is steeped in mythological significance relating to Sita and Lord Krishna.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

It holds supreme importance in Hindu rituals, specifically the Pind Daan ceremony. It is deeply connected to Hindu epics and Puranic literature.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to legends, the tree received a boon from Sita making it immortal, which is why it is called "Akshayvat" (the indestructible Banyan tree). According to the VedPuran, Lord Krishna stays under its shadow, and when the whole world drowns in water during dissolution, this tree will not die due to Sita's boon. Pinda Daan rituals start from Falgu River and conclude here.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Indestructible, everlasting Banyan tree
- The culminating point of the Pind Daan ritual
- Boon of immortality from Sita
- Puranic association with Lord Krishna

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

October to March

Opening Hours:

06:00 AM - 08:30 PM

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Drinking Water, Changing room & bathing facility

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Gaya International Airport

Distance From Airport:

09 Kms

Nearest Railway Station:

Gaya Junction

Distance From Railway Station:

05 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand:

Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan, Gaya

Distance From Bus Stand:

03 Kms

Road Connectivity:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (05 Kms)

Nearest Police Station:

Vishnupad Police Station (01 Km), Mob : 9431092838

Nearest Medical Facility:

Jay Prakash Narayan Hospital, Gaya (Mob : 9470003263), Anugrah Narayan Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya (Ph : 0631-221074)

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Vishnu Pad Mandir (02 Kms)
- Manglagauri Mandir (2.5 Kms)
- Pretshila (12 Kms)
- Mahabodhi Mandir (17 Kms)
- 80 feet Buddha statue (17 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Pind Daan rituals

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Performing Pind Daan rituals for ancestors.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel (9608556289)
- Ajatsatru Hotel (9798881223)

- Hotel Mantra Regency (9973357885)
- Hotel Royal View (9431224222)

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Harendra kumar (9708472519)
- Sanjeev Kumar (7488688556)
- Prakash Renukarjun (8809630151)
- Gautam Kumar (9934058927)
- Dinu Kumar Sinha (9199661740)
- Srikant Kr Mishra (9934794969)
- Deepak kumar (7992452814)
- Raviranjana Mishra (9939086249)

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels (8507192638)
- Vishal Tour & Travels (9006169000)
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels (8083329781)
- Surya Services (9431094940)

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The tree is considered indestructible due to a boon from Sita.
- The Pind Daan ritual finishes at this site.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Akshyavat is an everlasting Banyan tree located in Maranpur, Gaya. It is a highly sacred site for Hindus where the Pind Daan ritual concludes. According to mythology, the tree received a boon of immortality from Sita and is associated with Lord Krishna. The site is open from 06:00 AM to 08:30 PM (October to March). It is 9 km from Gaya Airport and 5 km from Gaya Junction. Facilities include parking, drinking water, changing rooms, and bathing facilities. Nearby attractions include Vishnupad Mandir and Manglagauri Mandir.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is an indestructible Banyan tree where the Pind Daan ritual concludes, believed to have a boon of immortality from Sita.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Maranpur, Gaya.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Vishnu Pad Mandir (02 Kms), Manglagauri Mandir (2.5 Kms), and Pretshila (12 Kms).

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: Visitors can reach via Gaya Airport (09 Kms), Gaya Junction (05 Kms), or Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan (03 Kms).

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Facilities include parking, drinking water, changing rooms, and bathing facilities.

KEYWORDS:

Akshyavat, Akshay Vat, Maranpur, Gaya, Banyan Tree, Pind Daan, Falgu River, Sita boon, Hindu pilgrimage.